Magazine Articles

About Magazine Articles

A **magazine** is a form of print media published on a regular schedule. Magazines can be published weekly, monthly, or even quarterly (four times a year). They usually contain photographs, advertisements, and articles by different writers. Some magazines cover subjects that appeal to a wide audience. Other magazines focus on a single subject. Some examples are

- runners
- knitters
- artists
- nature lovers
- animal lovers
- skateboarders

Reading Skill

Summarizing helps you review and understand the information you read. When you read a magazine article, look for **organizational patterns** such chronological order, cause and effect, and comparison and contrast. Subheads, photographs, captions, and maps often provide clues to a text's organizational pattern. You can **use these organizational patterns as guides for summarizing** different kinds of texts.

Text Features	Description
Title	The name of the article, which often gives clues about the topic
Subheads	Titles of sections that identify the main idea of each section
Photographs, illustrations, captions	Images and their labels that give additional information
Charts, graphs, diagrams	Information that is presented visually
Maps, legends	Images that show information about places

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Mongoose on the Loose

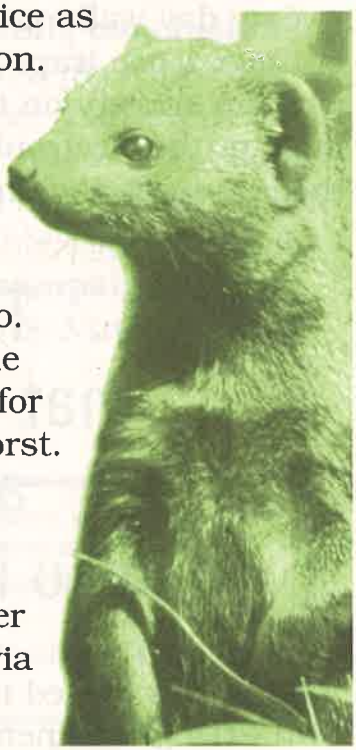
Larry Luxner

In 1872 a Jamaican sugar planter imported nine furry little mongooses from India to eat the rats which were devouring his crops. They did such a good job, the planter started breeding his exotic animals and selling them to eager farmers on neighboring islands.

Population Explodes

With no natural predators—like wolves, coyotes, or poisonous snakes—the mongoose population exploded, and within a few years, they were killing not just rats but pigs, lambs, chickens, puppies, and kittens. Dr. G. Roy Horst, a U.S. expert on mongooses, says that today mongooses live on seventeen Caribbean islands as well as Hawaii and Fiji, where they have attacked small animals, threatened endangered species, and have even spread minor rabies epidemics.

In Puerto Rico there are from 800,000 to one million of them. That is about one mongoose for every four humans. In St. Croix, there are 100,000 mongooses, about twice as many as the human population. "It's impossible to eliminate the mongoose population, short of nuclear war," says Horst. "You can't poison them, because cats, dogs, and chickens get poisoned, too. I'm not a prophet crying in the wilderness, but the potential for real trouble is there," says Horst.



According to Horst, great efforts have been made to rid the islands of mongooses, which have killed off a number of species including the Amevia lizard on St. Croix, presumed extinct for several decades.

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TAKE NOTES

Text Structure

Special features in magazine articles guide the reader. The title and photo help you know what the article is about. Subtitles break the article into smaller parts so that it is easier to read. What can you tell about this article from the title and subtitle?

Fluency Builder

Quotations, or words spoken by a person interviewed for the article, appear between quotation marks (" "). Underline the quotations in the bracketed paragraph. With a partner, take turns reading aloud the quotations, with expression.

Vocabulary Builder

Science Terms *Predators* are animals that kill and eat other animals. *Endangered species* are groups of animals in danger of becoming *extinct,* or dying out. *Rabies* is a very serious disease that affects dogs and other animals. *Epidemics* are occurrences in which a large number of animals or people have a certain disease at the same time.

TAKE NOTES

Vocabulary Builder

Science Terms *Life cycle* means "all the different levels of development that an animal or plant goes through during its life." *Reproductive habits* refers to the behaviors of plants and animals that produce baby animals or new plants.

Vocabulary Builder

Prefixes The prefixes *non-* and *un-* both mean "not." *Profit* means "money that you gain by doing business." *Willing* means "prepared to or wanting to do something." What do *non-profit* and *unwilling* mean?

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Text Structure

Words from an article are sometimes pulled out to highlight an idea or quotation from the article. Read the quotation at the bottom of the page. How does it help you preview the rest of the article?

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On Hawaii, the combination of mongooses and sports hunting has reduced the Hawaiian goose, or nene, to less than two dozen individuals.

Scientist Studies Problem

The fifty-nine-year-old biology professor, who teaches at Potsdam College in upstate New York, recently finished his third season at the 500-acre Cabo Rojo National Wildlife Refuge in southwestern Puerto Rico, using microchips to study the life cycle and reproductive habits of the Caribbean mongoose. (He is also doing similar work at the Sandy Point Fish and Wildlife Refuge on St. Croix in the U.S. Virgin Islands.) "I want to know what happens when you take a small animal and put him in an area with no competition. This is a model that doesn't exist anywhere else in the world."

Horst's five-year, $60,000 study is being sponsored by Earthwatch Incorporated, a non-profit group that has funded some 1,300 research projects in eighty-seven countries. Volunteers pay $1,500 each (not including airfare) to come to Puerto Rico for ten days and help Horst set out mongoose traps, study the animals, and keep records. Often he and his volunteers spend a sweaty day walking about ten miles while setting out mongoose traps in the wilderness. Later, they perform surgery on their unwilling subjects to implant the electronic devices that will allow them to track the animal's habits.

> "... This is a model that doesn't exist anywhere else in the world."

Horst has tagged more than 400 mongooses with PITs (permanently implanted transponders),

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A mongoose is tagged.

a new microchip **technology,** which he says has changed his work dramatically. "You couldn't do this with ear tags. It was very hard to permanently mark these animals until this technology came along," he said.

Horst has caught thousands of mongooses and has reached some interesting **conclusions.** Among them: mongooses have a life expectancy of six to ten years, much longer than the previously accepted figure of three years. Horst says his research will provide local and federal health officials[1] with extremely valuable information if they ever decide to launch a **campaign** against rabies in Puerto Rico or the U.S. Virgin Islands.

Everyday Words

technology (tek NAHL uh jee) *n.* new machines, equipment, and ways of doing things that are based on modern knowledge about science and computers

conclusions (kuhn KLOO shuhnz) *n.* things that you decide after considering all the information that you have

campaign (kam PAYN) *n.* a series of actions intended to achieve a particular result

1. **local and federal health officials** officials who work for local and national government

TAKE NOTES

Text Structure

Pictures and captions help you know more about the content of an article. Underline the text that tells you what the scientist is doing in the photo.

Vocabulary Builder

Suffixes The suffixes *-ally* and *-ly* both mean "in a particular way." *Dramatic* means "great and sudden." *Permanent* means "continuing to exist for a long time or for all time in the future." *Previous* means "having happened before the event or time that you are talking about." What do the underlined phrases mean?

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Comprehension Builder

Draw a box around the sentence that tells you one thing Horst learned by studying mongooses.

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